

Information Expression Review

Challenge Point — Framework (Current Working Version) · 2026-06-17

Round 8C found **Information** to be the weakest environmental dimension: the switch-play test resolved into spatial/overload problems rather than producing observable information-management demands. This review scoped the gap; the approved subset is now **built and gated on information intent**. It follows the framework rule: ground in the existing inventory, name the gap, propose **targeted** mechanisms — not rows for their own sake.

What “Information” means as an environmental dimension

Information is the **perceptual demand** the environment places on players — how much they must perceive, and how hard it is to perceive it, before and during action. It is not the same as space. Sub-levers: scanning demand, disguise/deception, uncertainty/variability, visual access (blind-side), time-to-perceive, and information delay.

Current coverage audit (before 8C)

The constraint rows carry a **visibilityEffect** field, but it encodes *cue salience* — how visible the **rewarded** action is — not *perceptual demand* or *information availability*. The library handled information only **passively** (spatial structures create things to read); it had **zero active levers** for disguise, uncertainty, visual-access restriction, or information delay. That is why Information read as flat in 8C.

The gap, by lever

Information lever	Coverage before 8C	Now
Scanning demand	Indirect (zones/support invite reading)	Multi-Goal Read
Disguise / deception	None	Disguised Restart
Uncertainty / variability	None	Variable / Late Target
Visual access (blind-side)	None	Blind-Side Entry
Time-to-perceive	Indirect (small area, time windows)	(via the above)
Information delay	None	Variable / Late Target

Decision & implemented subset

Signed off, built, and intent-gated. Four mechanisms approved; Pre-Scan rejected. Each shapes what is *perceivable* — scanning is expected to emerge as an adaptation, never rewarded directly.

- 1 **Variable / Late Target** (*uncertainty + delay*) — which target/gate is live is revealed late or changes, so teams read the live picture instead of pre-planning a route. *In an activity*: three gates across the far line; which scores isn't known until the attack reaches the middle third.
- 2 **Multi-Goal Read** (*scanning + uncertainty*) — two or three goals live at once, defended differently; the attack perceives which is open now. *In an activity*: small goals across the end line, all live; the open one keeps moving.
- 3 **Blind-Side Entry** (*visual access*) — advantage created from outside a defender's view is worth more; rewards the relationship, not a set run. *In an activity*: a finish from a run that arrived behind the last line counts double.
- 4 **Disguised Restart** (*disguise*) — scoped to variable-entry pictures: the ball enters from one of several last-moment locations, so neither team can rehearse (not a reaction/signal-guessing task). *In an activity*: each rep is served from a different gate chosen at the last moment.

Rejected — Pre-Scan Requirement

Framed honestly (“a forward pass counts only after a shoulder-check”), it rewards the scan itself — an observable *behavior*, not a change to the information landscape. If the environment genuinely hides information, scanning should emerge as an adaptation; if it doesn't, that is information for the coach, not something the activity should force.

Information layer vs. Observation layer

- **Information layer** (this review) — what is available, hidden, delayed, uncertain, or changing in the environment. Shaped by design.
- **Observation layer** — what coaches notice performers *doing* (scanning, anticipation, recognition). Observed, not forced.

The four approved mechanisms sit in the Information layer; Pre-Scan crossed into the Observation layer.

Intent gating (how they're triggered)

The mechanisms are gated on genuine **information intent**, not on which game problem is selected. A parser group fires on information-management language (read the picture, decide which option is open, play what you see, scan, perceive, recognize, anticipate, awareness/vision, disguise, variable/late target, blind-side) and selection boosts the information constraints only then.

- Information-intent goals surface them (typically 3-4).
- Pure space, possession, and defensive goals surface **none** — they no longer ride lens-alignment.

Connection to Challenge Calibration

Challenge Calibration's Demanding profile asks for “reduced or late information — disguised/varied starts and a faster-changing picture.” These mechanisms are what let it move the Information dimension. Follow-on: couple the Demanding level to the same selection bonus so it can invoke them even without information vocabulary in the goal.

Status & next step

- 1 **Done** — sign-off (four approved, Pre-Scan rejected), built, and intent-gated.
- 2 **Next (Christian)** — re-test the 8C / switch-play cases (with information-intent phrasing) to confirm Information now produces observable perceptual demands.
- 3 **Then** — the same lens applies to **incentive / value structures** and **transition-specific environments**.